

gside the subject line (before opening the email), don't ignore it! Some email clients show 90 characters, so there is some flexibility with length

Email content best practices

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Email copy should be clear and concise. Brevity is key. Think about conversion, not sharing every detail from the LP

Focus on value-first content and CTAs. Ask yourself: "what's in it for the subscriber?"

Avoid walls of text when possible - think facts, not fluff

Lead with benefits and add details where appropriate

Use extremely clear wording and remove words that don't provide value

1-2 CTAs per email is best practice (calls-to-action)

Take advantage of content hierarchy

Write for people not technology, this means you can use humor when it makes sense

Buttons should be no longer than 25 characters - 14 characters as a standard

Make sure that the size of your HTML file does not exceed 102kb, otherwise gmail will truncate your email and your email will be out of compliance.

If linking to the GitLab marketing site, make sure that the URL has a slash at the end of the link. Marketing site pages will not render if there are URL params and there is no trailing slash.

Design best practices

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Consider responsive design

Code all text in HTML

Minimize CTAs

CTAs must be in sentence structure caps (ex: Register now)

Images should add to the goal of your email and not take away from it

An email is not a landing page

Consider accessibility

In order to accomodate different clients and modes (dark mode, etc) header image requests to the design team must be for transparent images. This means that the image will not look right without a solid background in the email header. We cannot use a non-transparent image because they do not render properly in all clients.

A/B testing best practices

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Add your tests to the A/B testing tracker here

Each test group should include at least 1000 people

You need a bigger test group if you're testing for click-through rate versus testing for open rate

Have a goal and idea regarding what you want to improve and how your test is going to help with that

Test one variable at a time

Due to our small sample sizes, we recommend a full 50/50 split versus a 10/10/80 or 20/20/60

split

Remember your subject line or "from name" (testing open rates) could have an impact on click-through rate and conversion rate

Let the Campaign Manager know at the beginning of the project if you're interested in running an A/B test and what your goals/hypothesis is

Keep track of the split test learnings so we can learn and innovate!

Email KPI's that matters

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To view current benchmarks in Marketo, go to the Email Insights Tab.

The Importance of Content in Email Marketing:

Creating high-quality content within the body of the email is essential in email marketing for several important reasons:

Engagement and Audience Retention: Quality content captures the attention of your recipients and keeps them interested in what you have to say. An email with valuable and relevant content increases the likelihood that recipients will read the entire message and potentially interact with it.

Converting Leads into Customers: Good content can persuade your recipients to take action, such as clicking a link, registering for an event, downloading a resource, or making a purchase. Effective content can directly contribute to converting leads into customers.

Differentiation and Positioning: High-quality content sets you apart from the competition and positions you as a leader in your industry. You can share relevant information, updates, and insights that showcase your expertise.

In summary, developing good content within the body of the email is essential for attracting, retaining, and converting your recipients. A well-designed email filled with valuable content can make the difference between the success and failure of your email marketing campaigns.

Delivery Rate:

GitLab benchmark: 97%

Our delivery rate should be in the high 90s. Anything below this number needs to be addressed. A low delivery rate could be indicative of two things: poor list quality or the wrong email service provider.

How to calculate delivery rate: Number of emails delivered / number of emails sent.

Example: $950/1000 = 95\%$ Delivery Rate.

Open Rate:

GitLab benchmark: 23%

Importance of Subject Lines in Email Marketing:

Attracting Attention: The subject line is the first thing your recipients see when they receive an email. It should be compelling and relevant enough to immediately capture their attention and persuade them to open the email.

Increasing Open Rate: A good subject line can make the difference between an email being opened or ignored. A high open rate is essential for your message to reach your audience.

Conveying Value: The subject line should clearly and concisely communicate the value or benefit that the recipient will gain by opening the email. It should answer the question: "Why should I open this email?"

Creating Expectation: You can use the subject line to build anticipation or intrigue, which can motivate recipients to open the email to learn more.

Reflecting the Brand: Subject lines can also contribute to building your brand image. They should align with the personality and tone of your company.

Our email open rate is directly tied to our subject line and possibly our subheader. What is considered a good open rate will vary by industry, but on average, a healthy open rate may be anywhere between 15%-25%.

The KPI most directly impacted by the subject line is the Open Rate. This metric measures the percentage of recipients who opened your email compared to the total emails sent. An effective subject line can significantly increase this rate, indicating that more people are interested in your content and willing to engage with your messages.

For a software and web application company like GitLab, the average open rate percentage may vary, but a good benchmark is between 20% and 30%.

If our open rate is low, consider testing different subject lines or preheaders to see what style works best with our customers.

How to calculate open rate: $\text{Number of emails opened} / \text{number of emails delivered}$

Example: $200/1000 = 20\%$ Open Rate

Click Rate (CTR)

GitLab benchmark: 2%

The click rate is the measure of how many people who received the email clicked on CTA, image, or links within the body of the email.

The average click through percentages in email marketing campaigns for software and web application companies like GitLab can vary, but a good general benchmark is a CTR ranging from 2% to 5%.

This value can vary significantly depending on various factors, such as the quality of the subscriber list, content relevance, the effectiveness of calls to action (CTA), and proper audience segmentation.

That said, it's important to remember that the ideal CTR can vary from one company to another and largely depends on the specific goals of the campaign. Some campaigns may have a higher CTR if the content is highly relevant, and the audience is highly engaged, while others may have lower CTRs if they are sent to a broader and more diverse list.

How to calculate click-through rate: $\text{Number of clicks} / \text{number of emails delivered}$

Click To Open Rate:

GitLab Benchmark: 7%

There are several factors which could go into a low click-to-open rate, such as our email design, our content, our call to action - really any element in the body of our email.

It is a little more challenging to isolate what may be causing a low click-to-open rate, which is why we need to set up some A/B test splits to determine the cause.

How to calculate the Click To Open Rate: $\text{Unique Clicks} / \text{number of emails open}$.

Example: $50/200 = 25\%$

Opt-Out Rate:

GitLab Benchmark: 0.3%

Generally a good (low) unsubscribe (or opt-out rate) is below 0.2%. But anything above 1% is a problem. Determining why customers are opting out can be a challenge, so be proactive. Set up a brief survey for people who do opt out asking why.

How to calculate opt-out rate: $\text{Total Opt-outs} / \text{number of emails delivered}$.

Example: $5/950 = 0.5\%$ Unsubscribe Rate.

Email Templates

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Please see this issue for more details and to see how the email templates look

What are email templates? An email template is a reusable HTML file that is used to build email campaigns (according to Litmus).

Why are email templates important? Using an email template allows you to produce campaigns faster, since the underlying code is already written. Instead of having to rewrite an entire email from scratch for every send, you can simply add copy, images, and links to an existing template before testing and sending it to your subscribers (according to Litmus).

What email templates are available for us to use? In Marketo (Design Studio > Email Templates), the following email templates are available:

Template Name in MKTO	Use For	Image Specs (px, w x h)	Notes
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A - Event Invite v3.0	Events or asset downloads	Header background image - Transparent	
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background 600x345 | Top button is removable, The text version will need to be updated manually due to limitations with marketo variables |

| B - Advanced modular template - light mode | Larger events/assets with more modules to add with speakers | Header - Transparent background 600x345, Speaker images - 300x300 (2x the size) | Do not use all modules at once, The text version will need to be updated manually due to limitations with marketo variables |

| C - Simple email template | Assets/webcasts/events/anything | Background image - png 600x wide. Transparent background | Only use with 1 CTA |

| D - Letter format v1.0 | Any letter-like communication such as account update | N/A | N/A |

| E - Newsletter Dark Mode | DevOps Download developer newsletter only | The only image we swap out is the background image of the release section - 600px wide. The top image (infinity loop) is 600px wide also. | For DevOps Download newsletter only|

| F - Level Up Certification Invite Template | Level-up certification content | TBD | N/A |

| G - Event Invite with 2 buttons| Webcast invitations, events, ABM, anything really | Headline background image - 600x345; Speaker images - 300x300 (2x the size) | The text version will need to be updated manually due to limitations with marketo variables |

| H - Advanced modular template | Larger events/assets with more modules to add with speakers | Transparent background 600x345, Speaker images - 300x300 (2x the size) | Do not use all modules at once, The text version will need to be updated manually due to limitations with marketo variables |

Additional links/info:

- A - Event Invite v2.0 -- COPY DOC TEMPLATE
- B - Newsletter Dark Mode v1.0 (Only for use by the DevOps Download newsletter)
- C - Event Invite 2 buttons and speakers v1.0 -- COPY DOC TEMPLATE
- D - Letter format v1.0
- E - Newsletter Remote v1.0 (Only for use by the All Remote team)

Template notes

ABM Email Template - please use "Event Invite 2 buttons and speakers v1.0"

Nurture emails - please use "Event Invite 2 buttons and speakers v1.0"

Event invites or reminders - please use "Event Invite 2 buttons and speakers v1.0"

Privacy policy updates, account updates, or text-heavy emails - please use "Letter format v1.0"

If you don't have Marketo access and would like to see what the email templates look like, please view the project Epic and corresponding issues.

NOTE: It is very important that you format your copy to align with the design of the email template you're using. This will improve efficiency of building emails, and ensure copy is best fit to the layout.

What if I want a custom email template? You may submit a request for a custom layout, but please note that the critical priority currently is to efficiently launch emails and nurtures into market. In your request, please tag @aklatzkin and clearly describe why the existing layout is not satisfactory, how often and broadly the requested template will be used, and quantifiable benefits we anticipate from the new layout. To reiterate: Upon implementation of the critical emails and nurtures, we plan to devote more time and energy to developing and

testing new templates, however the launch of lifecycle emails takes precedence over these requests.

SECTION: marketing/lifecycle-marketing/email-processes-requests.md

Overview

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

This page focuses on emails processes, owned and managed by Lifecycle Marketing, Marketing Campaigns, and Marketing Operations.

Related Handbook: Email Management

GitLab Email Calendar

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

We have moved our email calendar to Asana! We will have email stakeholder syncs each Thursday to review emails for the upcoming two weeks. If you need the call added to your calendar, please ask Allie Klatzkin. To ensure this is done smoothly, please add your emails to the calendar as soon as you know that they are upcoming (regardless if you have all information).

All emails must be added to the calendar before the Email Stakeholder call the week before send. Emails added after the call will be pushed to the next week.

Due to limited seats, we will be providing 1-2 seats per team on the calendar. Please reach out to your team's DRI with any questions.

Calendar goal

Prioritize our emails to ensure we are sending the right emails to the right audience at the right time.

Provide visibility across teams on upcoming sends

Streamline communication and processes around emails

Process to add emails to the calendar:

Email issue templates, in Campaigns, Marketing Ops, Corporate Marketing, and Field Marketing projects, will have the ~email-calendar label on them which will automatically add emails to the calendar. If your issue does not have the ~email-calendar label, please add it to ensure visibility for the calendar.

Steps to add to the Asana calendar:

Ensure the label for "email-calendar" is added to your issue.

Add labels for the appropriate segmentation: "Global-email", "EMEA-email", "AMER-email", "APAC-email"

Add labels for appropriate email type: "operational-email" "non-operational-email"

Set email issue due date as the send date

Email Request Issue Template
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

PLEASE READ IMPORTANT NOTE IN SECTION ABOVE PRIOR TO SUBMITTING

To request an email send, please open an issue for consideration of your MVC email idea, and provide as much detail as possible (especially around the audience), and please respect if the determination is that "the juice isn't worth the squeeze" and that we may want to delay the launch until some foundational audience segmentations are established. Please review the Email Review Protocol section below for more detail.

SLA: There is a standard 5 Business Day SLA in place for new email requests. All details in the "Submitter Checklist" of the issue must be complete in order to be triaged to the appropriate Campaign Manager and/or Lifecycle Marketing Manager.

Please note: Invitation and follow-up emails will not be sent on Thursdays, due to our ongoing nurture programs.

Assign issues to: You must assign issues to the corresponding Lifecycle Marketing Manager for review before send.

@aklatzkin: Global, EMEA, Public Sector, Localized emails, Corporate Events, Newsletters
@alee: AMER, EMEA, Customer emails

Add the issue to the Asana email calendar: By default, issues will add the label for ~"email-calendar", you will need to add the label for your audience as well:

~"Global-emails"
~"AMER-emails"
~"APAC-emails"
~"EMEA-emails"

Urgent security emails are exempt from this SLA.

All links in email sends, going to about.gitlab.com will need to be appended with utm parameters, following the nomenclature outlined in this document. This is the way we track and give attribution to emails.

Need-to-know details for the email request
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Below are the information from the issue template that will need to be filled out before the Campaign Manager will create the email in the appropriate system:

Sender Name: Typically we use GitLab Team for most outgoing communications; for Security Alerts we use GitLab Security. Choosing a name that is consistent with the type and/or content of email being sent is important, if unsure make a note and we will make recommendation.

Sender Email Address: What email address should be used? Default is info@gitlab.com

Approvers: All approvers must be listed on the email request. At least one individual who will receive the replies to the email must be listed as an approver. For example, if the email is

coming from security@, someone who will receive replies to the email should be listed as one of the approvers. See approval table below.

Subject Line: 50 character max is preferred (30-40 characters for mobile devices)

Email Body Copy: Can be a text snippet within issue, clearly identified comment on issue or attach a Google Doc with copy. The copy must be approved before requesting the email.

Target Date to Send Email: at a minimum a few days notice is preferred because we need to balancing the number of emails being sent to our database so they are not perceived (or marked) as spam; however, a simple email can be turned in a few hours if absolutely necessary

Please note invitation and follow-up emails will not be sent on Thursdays due to our ongoing nurture programs

Recipient List: Emails can be sent to one of the existing segments or a recipient list can be provided as a .csv file

Audience should be appropriately segmented and tokens selected for personalization (if applicable)

All subscribers on selected list are opted-in to receive your message

If supplying a .csv file, the file must include the following fields: Email address, First Name (or Full Name)

If personalizing the email to reference a specific project or page, that field must be included in the .csv file and clearly marked using the same terminology used in the email copy. The email copy must clearly identify {{Project}} or {{Page}} where the applicable personalization should be inserted.

Types of email requests

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Go to this page to read more about email management and the different types of emails.

Approvals and notifications for email requests

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Marketing related ad-hoc emails are sent at the discretion of the Campaigns team.

Terms of Service or Privacy Policy updates that impact all users must be announced on the company meeting, in the whats-happening-at-gitlab and community-advocates Slack channels, and approved according to the table below prior to submitting the Email Request.

Support and Security emails sent to a small subset of users should be announced in community-advocates and supportescalations Slack channels, and mentioned in whats-happening-at-gitlab if relevant.

The approval table below applies to non-Marketing emails.

Users to be contacted	Approval by
< 1,000	reply-to owner
1,001-4,999	PR, reply-to owner, community advocate
5,000-499,999	PR, reply-to owner, community advocate, director+ in originating department
500,000+	PR, reply-to owner, community advocate, director+ in originating department, e-group member

Ad-hoc (one-time) emails
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Important note regarding audience segmentation efforts and efficiency
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Until our foundational Marketo database segmentations (noted in the overview at the top of this handbook page) are rolled out, there are challenges in targeting audiences efficiently. If you would like to propose an MVC email, please remember that the tactical execution may be beyond bandwidth constraints.

Steps to set up and edit emails
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

For one-time emails (i.e. a blast to promote a program for which we do not receive leads):

1. DEPENDENCY: target list issue must be complete before email can be sent (15 business day SLA to create target list)
2. Clone this Marketo email send template
 - Clone to: A campaign folder
 - Folder: Ad-hoc (one time) emails
 - Name: follow format of YYYYMMDDNameOfEmail where YYYYMMDD is date of send (i.e. 20210603DORAsurvey)
 - Description: Link to GitLab email issue
3. Update email in the send program
4. Update utmcampaign in Marketo My Tokens for email send

How-to videos:

Video on how to create an email
Video on how to edit an email

Target list creation
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Target list issue templates are an interim solution while foundational work is being complete for overall Marketo database audience strategy for lifecycle marketing engine.

Lifecycle Stage (Lead Status): (Raw, Inquiry, MQL, Accepted, Qualifying, Qualified)
Funnel Stage: (see options)
Sales Segment: (Large, MM, SMB, PUBSEC - if US PubSec, you can also specify territory (NSG, DoD, etc))
Region: (APAC, AMER, EMEA)
Sub-Region (East/West/PubSec or Southern/Northern/UKI/DACH):
Persona-Level: (see options)
Buyer Personas-Function: (see options)
Language Preference: (see options)
Activity filters (if necessary): (see options)
Inclusions: (if including records on previous campaigns, MUST include the name as appears on SFDC campaign, and campaign membership statuses to exclude)
Exclusions: (if excluding records on previous campaigns, MUST include the name as appears on

SFDC campaign, and campaign membership statuses to exclude)

Active lists

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To assist in building email target lists, MktgOps has developed a series of Marketo smart lists that can be used to determine how active a lead is based on specific time increments. Call on these smart lists to get the most up to date active user list for your email sends. The smart lists are located in the Database section of Marketo. They are:

- 01 Active List 30 days
- 02 Active List 60 days
- 03 Active List 90 days
- 04 Active List 6 months days
- 05 Active List 12 months
- 06 Active List 18 months

QA process

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

FY23-Q4: Lifecycle Marketing will be running a Q4 trial of reviewing all emails prior to send to ensure compliance with email best practices. Team members are responsible for reviewing and optimizing their own emails, following the latest email best practices from lifecycle marketing. Lifecycle will be partnering with email stakeholders to improve email performance and drive the best results for our campaigns, as well as maintain brand consistency across all email touchpoints.

FY24-Q1: In Q1 of FY24, we will share out how we will continue to scale the email review process.

Email workflow:

First step in requesting an email from lifecycle begins by creating an issue using the appropriate issue template in GitLab.

Team variations to QA process

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Campaigns: build the email yourself and have lifecycle QA.

FMM: Request the email to be built by MOps and send to lifecycle for approval.

Corp: using the process we outlined previously here

Campaigns Team QA process

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Submit final email for QA and scheduling

Step 1: Campaign manager: Submit an email issue for the appropriate email type and assign yourself and a lifecycle counterpart to your email. Be sure to include the proper labels for the email calendar. This needs to be done before the SLA date or at latest by Thursday at 9 am PT (with audience information) the week before send (i.e. if an email is going out the following Friday, it still needs to be in on Thursday the week before)

Step 2: Highlight your desired send date and time. (Will be reviewed and potentially modified by the Lifecycle team).

Step 3: Build the program and email in Marketo by referring to our email marketing best

practices and segment the email accordingly.

Step 4: Include a link to the Marketo program while submitting an Email issue request.

Step 5: Send a sample for lifecycle to QA

Global/EMEA/Localized/PubSec/Newsletters/Corporate/Intelligent Nurture = reviewed by Allie
Customers/AMER/APAC = reviewed by Alison

Step 6: Lifecycle will make revisions and send the email back to the campaign manager.

Step 7: Lifecycle will schedule the email to send at requested time slot

SLAS:

1. Larger events (GitLab 17 is typically Lifecycle owned, but events of similar scale): 7 business days

2. Tech demos: 5 business days

3. Email follow-ups: 2 business days

Field Marketing QA process

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Request for MOps to build the email

1. FMC/Etc puts in the issue request (per usual)

2. Mops reviews and puts in Triage if all pieces are in place (per usual)

3. When in triage, Mops adds a new label for Lifecycle Copy Review

4. Lifecycle reviews the copy, makes suggestions and does the back/forth with submittor

5. Once approved, Lifecycle adds the Lifecycle Copy Approved Label

6. Marketing Ops will then start to build the email

7. Once build, Mops will mark needing review for layout/format

8. Lifecycle approves layout/format

9. Mops deploys

Notes:

Lifecycle does not approve emails that we have a prebuilt template for (workshops, etc.)

For follow-up emails, lifecycle will still do a quick review of the copy in the new pre-built templates

Important note on 3rd party conferences/tradeshows

We only send emails for 3rd party conferences/tradeshows if they meet the following criteria:

1. They have a GitLab specific CTA (can be our own landing page, book a meeting link, activation registration page)

2. When we have a blind list account list or previous attendee audience to send the email to.

For more information on why we do this, please visit this issue.

Corporate Marketing QA process

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Request for Lifecycle to determine promotional content

Upon request, we will work with the Corporate Events team to promote and follow-up from our sponsored corporate conferences.

Promotion will only be done for Tier 1 events and events that have ancillary events added to them. We will promote to audiences who have previously attended the event, in addition to local audiences that match the persona. For full criteria and steps, please see this spreadsheet.

The process must kick off a month before the event, to ensure we have all of the relevant information for promotion and follow-up.

Newsletter QA process

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Full newsletter request information can be found here.

Email QA Checklist - Technical

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

The following outlines the technical QA that any email builder including Lifecycle, MOps, and Campaigns should complete after building an email. This also applies to anyone providing a secondary QA prior to deployment.

As the email builder, you are responsible for making sure the email is formatted properly according to our templates, that the links are formatted properly for tracking and use, that any tokenized sections are showing properly, the appropriate unsubscribe language is included, and any special requests from the business owner are displaying properly in the email in accordance with our template guidelines. You are not responsible for QA on spelling, grammar, dates/times, or links provided to you by the business owner (for example, if they drive to a webpage and provided you with the wrong link - as long as you formatted it properly in the email). If you notice inaccuracies in spelling/grammar, please update them in the email, but the business owner is responsible for those. You have joint ownership with the business owner to make sure the email looks good and is easy for the user to read.

Confirm that all tokens used in the email are complete in the program. This can vary from email to email, so you will need to check the email in the editor to confirm which tokens are in use. Generally, be sure to check {{my.landingpageURL}}, {{my.utm}}, the tokens for the title of the event, date, time, and in some cases intro paragraph and bullets. If anything is not complete and you do not have the information, ask the business owner to complete them.

Confirm that CTAs are in sentence case: ex: Register now (not Register Now)

Check the {{my.landingpageURL}} token to confirm that if you are driving to a page.gitlab.com address, there is NO / at the end of the url. If you are driving to about.gitlab.com, there should be a / at the end of the url. For example, the token should look like this (with no https://): about.gitlab.com/sixteen/ or page.gitlab.com/sixteen.

In the email editor, confirm that each link is hard-coded with https://. This cannot be in a token because the Marketo tracking will not work properly. Your links should look like this in the email editor: https://{{my.LandingpageURL}}?{{my.utm}}

In the editor, click on the text version of the email. The content should have been copied from HTML, but you will need to reformat it. Be sure that after you bring over the copy initially, you uncheck the "Copy from HTML" box. Format the email to use proper spacing between paragraphs and that the date/time information is easy to read.

In the text version, there should be no links in line with content. Move the links to the end of the paragraph or into separate bullets. You should have a "Register now" link at the top of the email and at the bottom. Confirm the links in the text version are formatted properly (as described above).

On the text version, you do not need unsubscribe text because Marketo will automatically

attach this if it is missing. If it is there, no need to remove it. The exception is if you are using the Localized email footer snippet. You do need to make sure this appears in the text version.

If dynamic content or snippets are not intended for the email, make sure no dynamic content is in use. In the email editor, click on "Dynamic" under the content section. If this is blank, there is no dynamic content in use. If it is not blank, click on the segment in use and it will highlight it in the email. If this is not intentional, select "Make Static" or "Replace with Rich Text" (depending on the type of dynamic content in use).

If you are using dynamic content or snippets, click on "Preview". Change the View by to "Segmentation". Select the segmentation, then be sure to preview the email for each segmentation option to make sure it displays as you expect. You can also send yourself a sample using each segmentation if you would like. You will need to provide screenshots or samples to the business owner to review the content in use for each segment.

Custom Header Image: If you are using the standard template with no changes to the header image, you can skip this step. If you are using custom header images (for example on large owned events), you must confirm that the image used was a transparent image. You can do this by looking at the design issue and confirming the image requested and provided by the design team is transparent. If you are working on a large event email (sending to 100k plus), you must also QA the email in Litmus.

View the email in Preview. Confirm all of the tokenized sections fill in properly and the name of the event, date, and time are showing correctly.

In Preview, hover over each link in the email and confirm the full URL is accurate with the correct UTM values. If any of this is incorrect, confirm that the https:// is hard-coded, check the {{my.landingpageURL}} token, and check the {{my.utm}} token. After you make any necessary changes, preview the email again.

After viewing in Preview, if the text in the header appears to be too large, resize it to be smaller so the line breaks make sense and the text isn't overbearing.

Send a sample to yourself. Click all links in the email and confirm they go where you expect them to. The links in your emails should have Marketo tracking codes, so when you get to the URL in your browser, confirm that the complete URL with utms is accurate. If the links drive to about.gitlab.com pages, it is recommended that you fill out the form and make sure the response is captured in Marketo.

On the sample you sent to yourself, confirm all tokenized sections filled in properly. Check the formatting and images on the email.

After your QA is complete, send a sample to the business owner for review.

Email QA Checklist - Business owner

The following outlines the business owner QA that the requestor (not builder) should complete before approving the email.

As the requestor/business owner, you are responsible for QA on content, spelling, grammar, dates/times, and links. You have joint ownership with the email builder to make sure the email looks good and is easy for the user to read, in line with our email best practices.

Check the pre-header information before you click on the email.

On the HTML version:

- Check the subject line, to and from details.

- Check the date, time, and event name/header.

- Read the subject line and email for spelling mistakes and grammar. Confirm the content is

accurate.

Review locations, agendas, or any other details included in the email.

Click on all links in the email. You must click on the links because the links are coded for Marketo tracking and will not show the URL until after you click on them. Confirm that all links go where you expect. You should also confirm that the utms (particularly the utm campaign value) is accurate.

Confirm the layout and text size in the header is what you expect.

You will also receive a text version of the email. This email is built separately from the HTML, so you must repeat your review on this.

Check the date, time, and event name/header.

Read the email for spelling mistakes and grammar. Confirm the content is accurate.

Review locations, agendas, or any other details included in the email.

Click on all links in the email. You must click on the links because the links are coded for Marketo tracking and will not show the URL until after you click on them. Confirm that all links go where you expect. You should also confirm that the utms (particularly the utm campaign value) is accurate.

If you requested dynamic content or if your email is localized, you may receive multiple versions of the email. Repeat the checks above for each version, confirming that the dynamic content is showing up as you expect.

For localized emails, confirm that the email footer is displaying in the requested language. This snippet displays based on the language preference of the user, with the default being English if they do not have a language on file.

Creating a nurture email program for the Intelligent Nurture

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

The following process is the technical process for creating a new email send program that is then activated in the appropriate streams/channels of the Intelligent Nurture. The project management process is integrated into the epic/issue creation for our core tactics that would be dropped into the nurture (new content, webcasts, workshops, analyst reports).

1. In Marketo, Clone this template

Clone into A Campaign Folder

Name the program with the following format: Type-ShortContentName (i.e. ebook-scaledci or webcast-simlificid or wrkshp-security)

Choose the folder: Master Email Programs (Intelligent Nurture)

1. Edit the email in the program

DO NOT UPDATE THE EMAIL CODE or you will break the email from the template.

Copy is indicated in the issue and should align to the email template.

If the email copy is missing an element (i.e. the CTA button is missing, or the subheader is not supplied), please comment in the issue to remind the copywriter of the template to follow.

1. Add the link to the new email in this spreadsheet in the column named: Link to New Marketo Program

If the content/webcast/offer is not listed, create a new row and fill out accordingly, making sure to note the UTM parameters (which are critical to proper reporting) and the Pathfactory URL.

Email review protocol

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

All Campaign Managers and reviewers should adhere to the following protocol for every marketing email that is sent to ensure brand consistency and quality in our email program. While the owner of the email should review the email, they must also assign the emails to the corresponding Lifecycle Marketing Manager as listed on the email templates.

Marketo is the primary system for all marketing emails and the regularly scheduled security updates. Iterable or Marketo should be used for emails to gitlab.com users as these users are not in our marketing systems (unless they have signed up for content).

To send an operational email, fill out an issue and follow protocol found [here](#).

Sales nominated flows in Marketo

In some cases, when invitations need to be more specific for an event, the Sales Nominated flows are used to allow sales to nominate who will receive the invite.

Note: if someone is nominated, but is unmailable (due to unsubscribe, invalid email, or hard bounce), they will not receive the invitation.

Activating the sales nominated flow in Marketo

Sales Nominated automation smart lists are applied to Marketo program templates where sales nominated flows are relevant.

Review the Email:

Send sample to the DRI for the program (i.e. workshop owner) who is responsible for testing and QAing the email. The email can be found under the Assets folder in the program. For some programs, the Marketo My Tokens are included in the Sales Nominated invite to make the email setup more efficient.

Review the smartlist and schedule recurrence of email:

Smart List (filter):

- Member of Program: (current program, registered status)

- Not Was Sent Email: (one of previous emails for this event) in last 7 days

- Subscription Filters (filters here are dependent on program type, and subject to change, so not adding all details)

Flow

- Send email: sales nominated email in the program

Schedule

- Choose Schedule Recurrence

- Schedule: Daily

- First Run: next relevant day to send (i.e. next business day available). Choose time of day relevant for timezone of event.

- Repeat Every: Weekday (M-F)

- End On: Day of the event

Removing sales nominated scheduled deployment

You can remove specific recurrences of scheduled sales nominated deployments. The FMC is responsible for this change for field marketing activities, and campaign managers are responsible for this change for demand generation activities.

To cancel a send, follow these directions.

Adding a nurture email program to Intelligent Nurture programs/streams

After you have created the Email Program (see above: Creating a nurture email program for the Intelligent Nurture) and tested your email (including checking UTM parameters), your email is ready to be activated in the Intelligent Nurture.

Work with the Campaigns Team to indicate the appropriate streams for the offer to be included (this is based on segment/region/funnel stage).

1. Navigate to the appropriate nurture program (i.e. AMER Enterprise)
1. In the appropriate stream (i.e. MQL > SAO), click the plus icon at the top.
1. In the Type section, select Program
1. In the Program Name section, begin to type in the name of the corresponding email program (i.e. ebook-10stepsciso) and select the program you created for this offer
1. In the Smart Campaign section, select 01 Send Controller
1. Now, click the gear icon for your program in the stream and either:
 - Activate if it is not an upcoming event
 - Edit Availability if it is an upcoming event and set the "End Date" for the date of the event. This will automatically stop the email from sending when the event has taken place.

Alignment of Offer Types (CTAs) in Intelligent Nurture Streams

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

The following is where different offer types should align in the email nurture streams. This is based on the essence of the offers, and the maturity of the person in terms of education about GitLab (i.e. advanced workshops are not a fit for RAW > INQ stream as these are leads who have taken no prior action with GitLab and should be receiving top funnel content).

SEE THIS DIAGRAM FOR WHERE CONTENT IS FIT FOR THE INTELLIGENT NURTURE

Adding an A/B test to Intelligent Nurture

Because our intelligent nurture is setup calling to programs, we cannot use Marketo's Champion/Challenger to A/B test emails.

Instead, we should take the following steps:

1. Build a second email and create a description of what was changed in the name i.e "Subject line test version" (or even saying the test)
2. Add it as a random sample in the send controller as shown in the flow below (use 50% for 2 versions, or split between 100% for more versions):

3. Monitor results on an email report
4. Document results on A/B testing tracker

Please see the A/B testing section below for best practices for conducting an A/B test.

Intelligent Nurture - Event promotion
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

In an effort to ensure audiences are not receiving duplicate emails and to streamline our own processes, we will be updating our current approach for promoting events via Intelligent Nurture and 2 email blasts. For now, all add to nurture issues that have duplicate email blasts will be cancelled. We will roll out a more comprehensive process in February.

For additional context, please see the issue [here](#).

Newsletter
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Process for monthly newsletter
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Open an issue using the Newsletter Request Template, including the newsletter send date in the issue title.

Epic of Past and Upcoming Newsletters

Creating the newsletter in Marketo
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

A day or two before the issue due date, create the newsletter draft. It's easiest to clone the last newsletter in Marketo:

1. Go to Marketing Activities > Master Setup > Outreach > Newsletter & Security Release
1. Select the newsletter program template [YYY.MM.DD] - New blog newsletter template, right click and select Clone.
1. Clone to A Campaign Folder.
1. In the Name field enter the name following the newsletter template naming format YYYYMMDDNewsletter Name.
1. In the Folder field select Newsletter & Security Release. You do not need to enter a description.
1. When it is finished cloning, you will need to drag and drop the new newsletter item into the appropriate subfolder (Bi-weekly Newsletters, Monthly Newsletters or Quarterly Newsletters).
1. Click the + symbol to the left of your new newsletter item and select Newsletter.
1. In the menu bar that appears along the top of your screen, select Edit draft.

Editing the newsletter in Marketo
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

1. Make sure you update the subject line.
1. Add your newsletter items by editing the existing boxes (double click to go into them). It's

best to select the HTML button on the menu bar and edit the HTML so you don't inadvertently lose formatting.

1. Don't forget to update the dates in the UTM parameters of your links (including the banner at the top and all default items such as the "We're hiring" button).

Sending newsletter test/samples from Marketo

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

1. When you're ready, select Email actions from the menu at the top, then Send sample to preview.

1. Enter your email in the Person field, then in Send to you can add any other emails you'd like to send a preview too. We recommend sending a sample to the newsletter requestor (or rebecca@ from the content team for marketing newsletters) for final approval.

1. When you are satisfied with the newsletter, select Approve and close from the Email actions menu.

Sending the newsletter

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

1. When the edit view has closed, click on the main newsletter item in the left-hand column.

1. If there are over 250,000 recipients due to be sent, you must request Marketing Operations to temporarily lift the Campaign Limits, otherwise the email will not send.

1. In the Schedule box, enter the send date and select Recipient time zone if the option is available.

1. Make sure Head start is checked too.

1. In the Approval box, click on Approve program.

1. Return to the newsletter issue and leave a comment telling requestor to double check all has been set up correctly. Close the issue when this is confirmed.

Template and process for mass-uploading issues for promotional events

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

1. Duplicate spreadsheet

Simple = 2 emails, follow-up for no show and attendee, audience sizing

Complex = multiple emails and follow-ups, audience sizing (think Commit)

2. Update issue titles in the 1st column

3. Update due dates in the 3rd column

4. Update template to have the epic by searching ("Command/CTRL F") EPICNAME then the three dots on the side and replace with your epic name.

For the following, you can update 1 issue then drag it down (at least for email descriptions):

5. Add any additional assignees at the bottom of the issue, it'll automatically assign to you

6. Choose any labels that you want added and add them to the bottom using /label ~"labelname"

7. Make any adjustments to audience, email names

8. Upload issue to the campaigns project using the import button. <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/marketing/demand-generation/campaigns/uploads/c644b04f8460d6f1007e731093ff16fc/ScreenShot2022-08-11at2.10.56PM.png>

22-08-11at2.10.56PM.png

9. Check to make sure your issues uploaded correctly and are in the right epic!

Adding "add to calendar" links in our emails without using 3rd party tools

Example:

Note: gmail inboxes a majority of our sends, according to litmus analytics pixel data. Outlook makes up 3-15% of our recipients. This is exactly what Limus did:

Learn More Here

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

You would have to copy and paste the information for the event from marketo to the tool above, this takes about 2 minutes

Make sure time zone is correct

[Add to Google calendar](https://www.google.com/calendar/event?action=TEMPLATE&dates=20200206T035000Z%2F2000206T065000Z&text=Nouts%20test%20event&location=5107%20Oakbrook%20Drive%2C%20Durham%2tails=nout's%20test%20event%20)

Add token to the email as follows:

Use Eventable in Marketo (not sure about price)

<https://www.eventable.com/info/add-to-calendar-marketo/>

Lifecycle Campaign Development Process

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

The Lifecycle Marketing Manger is responsible for coordinating execution of Free User campaigns. They will develop an initial strategy in collaboration with Growth Product, Marketing Ops, Data, and other teams. The steps to execute have certain issue templates, which are built into the process (see epic code below).

Overall Steps:

Team defines segment / PQL audience to target

Team collaborates/brainstorms approach

Lifecycle Marketer opens epic

Depending on approach decided, Lifecycle Marketer opens relevant issues (across teams)

Lifecycle Marketer outlines timeline

Lifecycle Marketer provides status updates to Free User Efficiency Project

Workback Timeline

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

The workback timeline is to be created by the Lifecycle Marketer to organize the execution of a new campaign. The workback is a starting point, to be discussed and agreed with the teams involved.

Workback Template

Epic Code

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

The Lifecycle Marketer will create the epic with the following structure. Issues will be created an related to this overarching epic to organize execution action items.

markdown

<!-- NAME THIS EPIC: Free User Campaign: [Name of Campaign] (i.e. Free User Campaign: active First Order namespaces without recent outreach from GitLab) -->

Campaign Execution Timeline >> - to be created by Lifeycle Marketer <!-- Template:

<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1Mrp0xNkpbfskvqDB-kFhhBqD-sNK86trx3qswOe6B0/edit?usp=sharing> -->

:star: Background and Scope

<!-- Provide a brief overview of the audience, campaign, and project. How did this idea arise? -->

<!-- Example: Target leads that have indicated that they are using GitLab for company use when signing up for free user license -->

:dart: Goal

Primary KPI:

Secondary KPI:
Measurement Plan (to be developed with Business Analytics)
- For reference: UTM Strategy Handbook

:bustinsilhouette: Team
Lifecycle Marketing: @Aklatzkin
Growth Product:
Marketing Operations:
Data Team:

:barchart: Supporting Data
<!-- Provide any links to raw data and analysis that drove the idea for this campaign. -->
<!-- Example: analysis of namespace <> sfdc account matchup that indicated we are missing opportunities to engage -->

:question: Open Questions
<!-- As we kickoff this campaign, what are existing open questions that we have? What do we need to address first? -->
<!-- Example: Are the users we are planning to target email compliant? Do some of these users already exist in SFDC? -->

:link: Links
<!-- Add links like target lists, Marketo programs, etc. -->
Add here
Add here

/label ~"dg-campaigns" ~"mktg-demandgen" ~"mktg-status::wip"

Action Streams

Currently available Action Streams. Please use the values below to populate the Marketo {{my.Action Stream}} token. These must be exactly as written:

Security
Compliance

Instructions for routing to Action Streams is available on the Campaigns & Programs page. Video Instructions.

SECTION: marketing/lifecycle-marketing/emails-nurture/index.md

Overview

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

This page focuses on emails and nurture programs, owned and managed by Lifecycle Marketing, Marketing Campaigns, and Marketing Operations. We are focused on progressing leads throughout their funnel and have programs encompassing prospects (aimed at progressing Unknown > Inquiry >

MQL > SAO) and product user journeys (free > trial > paid campaigns). We leverage "always on", logic-based, trigger-based, and persona-driven nurture engines.

Please visit our other pages for more information on email best practices, email processes and requests, and general team information.

Related Handbook: Email Management

Key foundational elements to achieve this:

- A strategically segmented Marketo database

 - this is an ongoing effort led by MOps in collaboration with Campaigns

 - please see note below regarding segmentation and email requests

 - see this documentation for Marketo segmentations

- A prescriptive persona-based buyer's journey (Persona nurture)

 - this is an ongoing effort led by Lifecycle in collaboration with Campaigns, Content

 - Marketing, and Product Marketing

 - see this section of the handbook page for more info

 - see the epic for more information

- User nurtures and programs

 - this is an ongoing effort led by Lifecycle, and specifically spearheaded by our Manager,

 - Lifecycle Marketing @Aklatzkin.

 - see this epic for holding location of projects to be prioritized

Quick Links

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

- Combine nurture epic

- FY26 Persona Nurture epic

- FY26 Trial Nurture epic

- All nurtures: CTA & UTM documentation

Email Nurture Programs

Persona Email Nurture

The Persona Nurture (formerly the Intelligent Nurture after relaunch on 2023-11-06) aims at progressing leads from RAW > INQ > MQL > SAO, and leverages segment/region data to provide the right offer to the right person at the right time - based on their region and persona.

We shifted to the persona model in November of 2023 to scale our programs more easily and enable team members to optimize the programs more regularly. The next iteration for FY25 Q4 will be to launch action streams, which are personalized interest based email streams based on the content the lead came in on.

Quick Links

- FY26 Persona Nurture epic

- Combine nurture epic

- Figjam of Persona Marketo Email Nurture

Marketo Program
CTA & UTM documentation of existing nurture

Persona Email Nurture Stream Schedule
<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

The following shows the day of the week and cadence of the different streams in the Persona Nurture:

AMER: Thursday, 8:30 AM PT
EMEA: Thursday, 1:00 AM PT
APAC: Wednesday (Thursday APAC time), 6:30 PM PT
LATAM: Thursday, 8:30 AM PT.
Localized
Spanish: Inactive - leads rerouted to English nurtures
French: Thursday, 1:00AM PT
German: Inactive
Japanese: Wednesday (Thursday JP time), 5:00PM PT
Korean: Wednesday (Thursday JP time), 5:00PM PT
Portuguese: Inactive - leads rerouted to English nurtures
PubSec User/Buyer: Thursday, 7:00AM PT

Persona Nurture Reporting Process

All Nurtures within persona nurture have their link directly to their specific report.

Which are formed as follows:

REGIONAL NURTURES

AMER
APAC
EMEA
LATAM
AMER PubSec

LOCALIZED NURTURE:

LOC-FRENCH

LOC-GERMAN

LOC-JAPAN

LOC-KOREA

LOC-PORTUGUESE

LOC-SPANISH

Action streams

In FY26 Q1, we began evolving our person-based nurture strategy by launching our first intent-based nurture program, where we tailor our messaging based on our lead's interest.

These send weekly at the same time as our Persona nurture.

Example of how this works:

Lead comes in on security asset and we send security content.

Lead comes in on an industry asset or is segmented into an industry, then they would go into the industry action stream

What happens after they finish the action stream?

Go back into the persona nurture

Once we have other nurtures, can go into recycled or whatever level makes sense

Flow (New):

New person created, add to action stream based on program token

If preferred language one that we have a nurture stream for, bypass action stream and put in localized nurture

If customer, do not put in action stream, put in regional nurture

If they come in from a trial, they will go through trial nurture. If they qualify for an action stream before trial nurture completes, do not move to action stream. After trial, move to regional nurture.

After they exhaust content on action stream, move to regional nurture

If emailable status changes, pause nurture

Requested Flow (Existing)

If existing person has not exhausted content on regional nurture, do not move to action stream

If content is exhausted or they aren't in regional nurture, move to action stream

If customer (or segment changes to customer), move/keep in regional nurture

If they take a trial, pause Action Stream, move to trial nurture. Restart action stream when trial nurture completes

After action stream content is exhausted, move to regional nurture

If preferred language changes (from EN or other language we send EN nurture to), move to localized nurture

If emailable status changes, pause nurture

Links

1. FY26 action stream'
2. Action stream routing
3. FY25 action streams
4. Action stream email documentation

User nurtures (GitLab product users)

Trial nurtures

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Goal: Educate trialers about key features to use during 60 day period and give them materials to consider upgrading or purchasing an add-on.

Delivery System: Iterable (GitLab.com) & Marketo (SM)

Figma file - with all trial experiences

FY25 Ultimate + Duo Enterprise Trial Nurture

Email copy doc

FY25 Trial Nurture Epic - old

Trial Nurture Variations

Following the launch of Duo Enterprise trials, we have several different trial nurtures running in either Iterable or Marketo. These nurtures send to the Owner role who starts the trial. The goal of these programs is to drive usage for Ultimate + Duo Enterprise and in turn influence conversion:

Existing/New Free GitLab.com users · GitLab Ultimate + Duo Enterprise

Copy

Figma

All links & UTMs

Iterable link

Existing Premium SKU users · GitLab.com Ultimate + Duo Enterprise

Copy

Figma

All links & UTMs

Iterable link

Existing Ultimate users · GitLab.com Duo Enterprise standalone

Copy

Figma

All links & UTMs

Iterable link

Existing Premium SKU users - GitLab Duo Pro standalone

Copy

Figma

All links & UTMs

Iterable link

Self-managed nurtures are sent from Marketo and are typically very similar to GitLab.com nurtures with slight variations (no login links):

GitLab Self Managed Duo Enterprise - Ultimate only

Figma

Marketo link

GitLab Self Managed Duo Pro - Premium only

Figma

Marketo link

GitLab Self managed Ultimate trial

Figma
Marketo link

There are several localized nurtures that have launched for GitLab.com Trials. These are not up to date with Duo information, as Duo is only available in English currently. These are the localized nurtures:

Iterable routing

French:

Figma
Iterable link

German:

Figma
Iterable link

Japanese:

Figma
Iterable link

Free User Onboarding Email Campaigns

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Sent through Iterable

We recently moved what was formerly known as "In-product emails" from Mailgun to our newer Iterable system. This will allow greater flexibility and iteration.

Slide deck showing past and current state

FY24 Epic

Figma journey

These are also known as:

User onboarding emails

Free user nurture

User nurture

User emails

Any sort of combination of the above

We launched these for:

Free SaaS users - Beginning of Feb, 2021, moved to Iterable in August 2023

Free Self-managed users - Launched mid-late May, 2021, moved to Iterable in August 2023

Iterations:

We relaunched these emails in Iterable and turned off Mailgun. Send time is now based on when the user joins GitLab and implemented skipping weekend send dates. In August 2023, we launched a welcome email and simplified some of the content. We will be iterating more on this program going forward.

Who's part of this project?

Allie Klatzkin - email marketing DRI, Iterable analytics, & assist technical setup
Paige Cordero (Growth)
Gayle Doud (Growth)

So what's the deal?

Basically, we have a series of emails that deploy to net new namespaces. The goal is to get free users to use features of the product. There are 4 tracks - adopt Create, adopt Verify, invite Team, try a Trial. Each track has emails that try to nudge users to take action. If a user takes the action referenced in the email, they will not get the next email in the series and will move to the next series.

From email and reply-to email

info@mg.gitlab.com - which is a group inbox. Amy is also a member of this group inbox.

HTML files

All of the HTML email files are in Iterable.

For a more in-depth look at how these emails work, please review the Figma journey.

Invited users

Please note we are limited in what we can send to this audience.

Goal: Enable users who are invited to get started using GitLab

Delivery System: Iterable (SaaS) & Marketo (SM)

Programs:

Onboarding

Duo Pro Seat allocation

SECTION: marketing/localization/_index.md

Introduction

Localization team collaborates with the Marketing, Sales, Product and Engineering divisions, as well as external partners (vendors) and the wider community of translators, to enable GitLab's global reach and user experience across key pillars: Marketing (about.gitlab.com), Editorial (blogs), Product, Documentation, and Enablement (support, customer success, etc.).

The key initiatives around strategic localization of content and materials include increasing our non-English blog publishing cadence and performance, enabling localization of docs.gitlab.com, launching our comprehensive terminology management system, deploying cutting-edge Generative AI and machine translation solutions, and expanding into customer-facing programs including Support content localization and training & certification materials.

Our ability to support regional teams with localized product documentation, marketing content, and customer success materials directly impacts GitLab's ability to grow in international markets.

Meet our team

- Daniel Sullivan, Director, Globalization & Localization
- Oleksandr Pysaryuk, Senior Manager, Globalization Technology
- María José Salmerón Ibanez, Senior Localization Program Manager
- Megumi Uchikawa, Senior Localization Content Manager
- Maud Leuenberger, Senior Localization Content Manager, French
- Hendrik Breuer, Senior Localization Content Manager, German
- Rasam Hossain, Senior Fullstack Engineer
- Lauren Barker, Staff Fullstack Engineer
- Noriko Akiyama, Localization Specialist, Japanese
- Emi Kimura, English-Japanese Linguist

temporary service provider

Localization technology management

The Localization team is managing the rich technology stack consisting of several purpose-built custom internal tooling and solutions, as well as commercial Language Technology Platforms (LTPs) for managing the localization of GitLab product UI, marketing website and content:

- The Localization Request Management system and its suite of integrations and microservices, aka Argo
- The GitLab Translation Service aka Argo GitLab Integration
- Argo integrations and automations between LTPs (language technology platforms), such as TranslationOS and Phrase TMS, and GitLab projects and systems, such as Contentful, Decap CMS, Marketo and others
- Purpose-built custom AI-powered solutions for machine translation and localization-adjacent tasks for GitLab product documentation. See project Tech Docs AI-powered translation
- Purpose-built custom solutions for context-enhanced localization of GitLab product UI, using Crowdin. See project GitLab String Search, epic Implement and launch the string search context-enhancement solution as Pages website, and project Crowdin Automation
- Argo GitLab Agent, i.e. a purpose-built microservice / component of the Argo ecosystem for specialized localization-related tasks, such as file pre- / post-processing, etc.
- Terminology management system - Kalcium Quickterm

Localization Program Management

Localization Engineering

Contact us

The Localization team manages general localization-related, language-specific and partner-specific Slack channels:

- localization: Central channel for translation and localization questions, requests, and collaboration with the Localization team.
- tech-docs-localization: Channel for quick communication and interactions between, mainly, the Localization team and the Technical Writing team.
- blog-localization-content: Channel for communication around our international blogs

- translated-team: For communication with our language services provider, Translated.
- spartan-software: For communication with our technology partner, Spartan Software.
- oban-international: For communication with our copywriting and digital marketing agency, Oban International.
- crowdingitlab: For communication with our technology provider for product UI text localization, Crowdin.
- argosmultilingual: For communication with Argos Multilingual, our language services, solutions and technology provider for product and technical documentation.
- terminology: For communication with our terminology consultant, vendors (Translated and Argos Multilingual) and the technology provider of the terminology management system, Kaleidoscope.
- japanlocalizationgitlab: For localization questions and collaboration between Japanese-speaking team mates, stakeholders, and language specialists from Translated.
- french-localization: For collaboration between GitLab and language specialists from Translated.
- german-localization: For collaboration between GitLab and language specialists.
- italian-localization: For collaboration between GitLab and language specialists.
- portuguese-brazil-localization: For collaboration between GitLab and language specialists.
- spanish-localization: For collaboration between GitLab and language specialists.
- french-localization: For collaboration between GitLab and language specialists.

Labels

Localization request status labels

Label	Purpose
-----	-----
L10n-status::triage	To triage localization requests or initiatives
L10n-status::New Reque	